Table 1. Key Recommendations by Executive, Independent, and Congressional Sources to Combat Terrorism and Close Terrorist Safe Havens

Key document	Source	Recommendation
National Strategy for Combating Terrorism, 2003	President Bush and the NSC	• Called for comprehensive plans employing all elements of national power—diplomatic, military, intelligence, development assistance, economic, and law enforcement support—to combat terrorism • Gave State lead to develop coordinated plans; all appropriate departments were to develop supporting strategies • Directed Defense, State, and intelligence agencies to annually assess and develop plans to close safe havens
		•
9/11 Commission Report, 2004	9/11 Commission, an independent, bipartisan study group mandated by Congress in 2002	• Stated that long-term success demands coordinated, comprehensive, multidepartment efforts employing all elements of national power • Recommended that a single entity be responsible for comprehensive, multidepartment planning for U.S. efforts to combat terrorism • Recommended U.S. (1) make a long-term, comprehensive commitment to assist Pakistan to combat terrorism and (2) develop a strategy to close safe havens
Intelligence Reform Act, 2004	Congress	• Authorized creation of the NCTC to develop comprehensive, multidepartment plans to combat terrorism employing all elements of national power • Stipulated that such plans should include (1) the mission, (2) objectives, (3) tasks to be performed, (4) interagency coordination, and (5) roles and responsibilities. It also tasked the NCTC with monitoring each agency involved • Required a report within 180 days of passage of the act on the administration's strategies for (1) closing terrorist safe havens and (2) assisting Pakistan to combat terrorism
9/11 Commission Act, 2007	Congress	• Required the President to submit a report by November 2007 on the strategy, employing all elements of national power, to combat terrorism in the FATA

Source: GAO analysis of key documents.

Despite Executive, Congressional, and Independent Calls for Comprehensive Plans to Combat Terrorism and Close Terrorist Safe Havens, Such Plans Were Never Developed

As table 1 shows, the need for the development of comprehensive plans employing all elements of national power—diplomatic, military, intelligence, development assistance, economic, and law enforcement support—to combat terrorism and close terrorist safe havens has been recognized by the President's national security strategies (2003), the independent 9/11 Commission (2004), and by Congress in repeated legislation (2004 and 2007). As it became clearer that al Qaeda had retreated from Afghanistan into Pakistan and was creating a safe haven in the FATA, Congress increased its demands on the U.S. administration to

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